

Border Forge Quick Start

MAP + BLITZ + FORTIFY - v3 | 18 September 2026

Get your family connected

Start here

Border Forge is a turn-based territory game. Aim to be the last commander standing. The computer runs the game and shows the board; phones are controllers for people watching that shared screen. You can cast or mirror the computer to a TV using your normal display setup.

Open the current game

Computer: <https://borderforge-controller-test.onrender.com/>

Phone: <https://borderforge-controller-test.onrender.com/controller.html>

Check for MAP + BLITZ + FORTIFY - v3 on the phone page. For phone play, use this Render version rather than the older itch.io build.

Set up on the computer

1. Choose **Local / Hot-Seat**, **Frontier Command** and **Quick Deploy**. Quick game length is a manageable starting point. Turn off the guided tutorial for the first phone-controller game.
2. Set Human Commanders to the number of people playing. Choose AI opponents as desired. The game supports up to four humans and five commanders total; check the setup screen before starting.
3. Open **Phone setup**, then **Connect a phone**. Keep the computer game open.

Join and assign phones

4. Each player opens the phone link above, enters the room code shown on the computer and their name, then taps **Join room**. Internet access is required on all devices.
5. On the computer, choose **Start game with current settings**. With one phone and one human, assignment is automatic. With multiple humans, use Phone setup to assign each phone to a different human commander.
6. When prompted, confirm the commander handoff on the computer. The active player chooses a capital by tapping an owned territory on their phone and confirming.

First family session

Try one complete round before settling into a longer game. Confirm that each phone controls the intended commander and that everyone can see the TV or computer. Keep one person available at the computer for handoffs and special decisions. Landscape orientation and Zoom in can make the phone map easier to tap.

Play a complete turn

1 Reinforce

Tap your territory, enter the number of armies, select the placement button and confirm. Repeat until your reinforcements are placed, then choose **Continue to attacks** and confirm. If the game requires a card trade, complete it on the computer.

2 Attack

Tap your territory with at least two armies, then a highlighted enemy target. **Attack one round** resolves one combat round, not necessarily one army. A legal source and target stay selected for another round. **Blitz until exhausted** repeatedly attacks that target until capture, exhaustion or the game's stopping limit. Review and confirm your choice; blitz can use up your attacking force.

After a capture

Follow any army-advance prompt and choose the number to move. Desktop blitz behavior can move armies automatically without a separate prompt. Check the shared board. You may continue attacking or choose **Finish attacking** to enter Fortify.

3 Fortify and finish

Tap a friendly source with at least two armies, then a highlighted friendly destination. It may be reached through a chain of your territories. Enter an amount, choose **Move armies & end turn**, then confirm. Leave at least one army at the source. **One fortification ends your turn**. To skip the move, choose **End turn without fortifying**.

Use the advisor

Read the recommendation and its reason. **Review recommended move** selects a supported action and suggested army count for you to review. You can change the count or cancel. Recommendations are advice, not guaranteed outcomes. Some recommendations must be carried out on the computer.

If the phone stops offering moves

Check whose turn it is and read the message on your phone. Handle any handoff or open dialog on the computer. For a lost connection, keep the host open and allow the phone to reconnect. If the room has ended, create a new room and reassign phones. Do not reload the host as your first troubleshooting step.

Keep this in mind

Cards, research, promotions, diplomacy and some dialogs still use the computer. Remote online computer games are a separate mode and cannot currently share a game with these phone controllers. Save from the computer before a break; saving the campaign does not preserve the phone room.